

Notepad++ also facilitates suggestions for the arguments of functions, which is specific to the language.

7) Search and Replace

The search and replace function is quite advanced in Notepad++ as you can find and replace text either in the current file or even in multiple files in a folder, that too recursively. You are also given the option to find and replace text using regex. You can use it to search not just open files but also the files in a directory or sub-directory.

Compare Plugin

This is undoubtedly one of the best features of Notepad ++ and certainly needs a special mention. What this plugin effectively does is to compare an old version of your work with a new version of it. When you perform the comparison action, Notepad ++ displays the differences between the two works side-by-side. It goes one step ahead by letting you set any of the two files as the default one by clicking on “Set as First to Compare”. After this, it lets you choose the selected file to compare with other ones in any mode of your choice.

The comparison plugin lets you use different colours and symbols to denote any variations in the file. There are 4 changes you can track – added, deleted, moved or changed line.

Added means that the line has been newly added in the new file but not in the old file. The highlighted colour will be green. Removed means that a particular line was removed from the new file. The removed line will be highlighted in red in the old file. A moved line means that the line was moved from one location to another location. Changed means that the line is almost identical with minor changes. The minor changes are highlighted in orange

There is a navigation bar at the right-hand side of Notepad++ that is extremely useful when you are comparing large files. In such files, it is almost impossible and time-consuming to navigate the whole file by moving up and down to find the differences. This is where the navigation bar turns into a sitemap that gives you a holistic view of the file.

The comparison plugin has many practical uses. Here are some of them –

- Let us say you are working on code along with many others. You want to see what changes the other people made on your code. This is easily possible with the comparison plugin.